

Terminal

template.html birthday.html x main.py

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html>
3 <head>
4 <meta charset="utf-8">
5 <title>Birthday</title>
6 </head>
7 <body>
8 {% extends "template.html" %}
9 {% block content %}
10
11 <h2> Enter your birthday to find out </h2>
12
13 {% endblock %}
14 </body>
```

Guide

Collapse

Creating Templates

Parent Template

Start the `birthday` virtual environment.

```
conda activate birthday
```

Flask is built around a templating system. So before we render any HTML, we need to design a parent template that will serve as the foundation of our app. Because our app is so simple, our parent template will contain the title `Is it My Birthday?`, which will appear on every view. The most important part of this template is the content block. This block is where information from other views will be displayed. Use the link to open the parent template and copy/paste the following code into the file.

Open `template.html`

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<meta charset="utf-8">
<title>Parent Template</title>
</head>
<body>
<header>
<h1 class="title">Is it My Birthday?</h1>
</header>

{% block content %}
{% endblock %}

</body>
</html>
```

Birthday Template

Now that we have the parent template, we can create children templates that inherit from the parent and provide information in the content block of the parent. The most important parts of a child template is the `extends` statement that inherits from the parent and the block content tags. Whatever appears in the block content tags of a child will be placed into the block content tag of the parent. Click the link below to open the `birthday.html` template.

Open `birthday.html`

Copy and paste the code below into the IDE. This is the `birthday.html` template, which will serve as the first thing you see when loading the page. For now, we are going to keep it simple. There is only a single `<h2>` tag in the content block. That means the parent template has an `<h1>` tag and the child has an `<h2>` tag. Rendering `birthday.html` will show the `<h1>` content from its parent and its `<h2>` content.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<meta charset="utf-8">
<title>Birthday</title>
</head>
<body>
{% extends "template.html" %}
{% block content %}

<h2> Enter your birthday to find out </h2>

{% endblock %}
</body>
```

Before we can see our templates, we need to make changes to the `main.py` file so that it renders HTML instead of returning a string. Click the link below to open the `main.html` file.

Open `main.py`

Because Flask is built around templates, this is a rather easy thing to do. We are not doing any data manipulation on the backend, we simply want Flask to render an HTML document. First update our import statement to import `render_template`.

```
from flask import Flask, render_template
```

Then, update the `birthday` function so that it uses `render_template` and pass it `birthday.html`. This will render all of the HTML for `birthday.html` and its parent template as well.

```
@app.route('/')
def birthday():
    return render_template('birthday.html')
```

► Did you notice?

Open the terminal by clicking the link below. Then enter the command to start the Flask app.

Open terminal

```
python birthday/main.py
```

Then preview our app with the following link. You should see the title from the parent template and the text telling you to enter your birthday. The font should have the basic styling of the `<h1>` and `<h2>` tags.

Open Flask app

In the terminal, stop the Flask app with `Ctrl + C` and then deactivate the `birthday` virtual environment.

```
conda deactivate
```

Reading Question

What syntax does Flask use to designate a content block in an HTML document?

☐

`{% block content %}`
`{% endblock %}`

☒

`{% block content %}`
`{% endblock %}`

☐

`{% blockcontent %}`
`{% endblock %}`

☐

`{% beginblock %}`
`{% endblock %}`

The correct answer is:

`{% block content %}`
`{% endblock %}`

Flask uses `{% content block %}` (two separate words) to mark the beginning of a content block and `{% endblock %}` (all one word) to mark the end of a content block.

Check Me

Next